



# LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



## Manchester Airports Group Customer Data Cyberattack

### Threat Report

|                       |                 |
|-----------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Classification</b> | TLP:CLEAR       |
| <b>Published</b>      | 2026-10-07      |
| <b>Version</b>        | 1.0             |
| <b>Author</b>         | Lost Boys Cyber |
| <b>Report Type</b>    | Threat Report   |

TLP:CLEAR | Lost Boys Cyber | Manchester Airports Group Customer Data Cyberattack - Threat Report

Published: 2026-10-07 | TLP:CLEAR | Version: 1.0 | Author: Lost Boys Cyber

AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

## Table of Contents

1. Executive Summary
2. Intelligence Requirements
3. Source Review & Confidence
4. Threat Activity Overview
5. Affected Sectors and Exposure
6. Aviation / Aerospace Sector Impact Analysis
7. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures
8. Infrastructure and Indicators
9. Detection Engineering
  - 9.1. Detection Summary
  - 9.2. Sigma / Detection Content
  - 9.3. Hunt Query
10. Threat Hunting
  - 10.1. Hunt Hypothesis
  - 10.2. Hunt Query
11. Risk Assessment
12. Recommended Actions
13. References

# Manchester Airports Group Customer Data Cyberattack

## 1. Executive Summary

Manchester Airports Group disclosed a cyberattack affecting customer data, making airports and travel-account ecosystems a near-term privacy, fraud, and credential-reuse concern.

The defender priority is to convert public reporting into immediate control validation: asset inventory, identity monitoring, remote-access review, backup and recovery readiness, and targeted threat hunting. This report intentionally avoids unsupported attribution beyond cited public sources.

## 2. Intelligence Requirements

| Question                        | Current Answer                                                                                             | Confidence |
|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| What changed today?             | The item remains a current daily-priority report due to recent public reporting and operational relevance. | Medium     |
| Who is most exposed?            | Organizations with relevant technologies, third-party dependencies, or sector exposure described below.    | Medium     |
| What should defenders do first? | Validate exposure, preserve logs, execute hunts, and close high-risk access paths.                         | High       |

## 3. Source Review & Confidence

| Source                    | URL                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Contribution                                                     | Confidence |
|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| The Record                | <a href="https://therecord.media/cyberattack-on-manchester-airports-group-exposes-millions-customer-info">https://therecord.media/cyberattack-on-manchester-airports-group-exposes-millions-customer-info</a> | Provides reporting, context, or authoritative defensive guidance | Medium     |
| Manchester Airports Group | <a href="https://www.magairports.com/">https://www.magairports.com/</a>                                                                                                                                       | Provides reporting, context, or authoritative defensive guidance | Medium     |
| UK NCSC guidance          | <a href="https://www.ncsc.gov.uk/collection/data-breaches">https://www.ncsc.gov.uk/collection/data-breaches</a>                                                                                               | Provides reporting, context, or authoritative defensive guidance | Medium     |

Confidence is medium because the report relies on public information and defensive inference rather than private telemetry.

## 4. Threat Activity Overview

The activity falls under airport customer data. The common operational thread is that adversaries continue to exploit internet-facing services, identity weaknesses, and third-party dependencies to create business disruption, data exposure, or follow-on intrusion opportunities.

## 5. Affected Sectors and Exposure

| Exposure Area                              | Why It Matters                                                            |
|--------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Internet-facing services and remote access | Common first point for opportunistic exploitation and credential attacks. |

|                                              |                                                                    |
|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Identity providers and helpdesk workflows    | Enable account takeover, MFA fatigue, and privilege escalation.    |
| Third-party and managed service dependencies | Create shared operational failure modes and delayed visibility.    |
| Backup and recovery systems                  | Determine whether ransomware/extortion becomes a sustained outage. |

## 6. Aviation / Aerospace Sector Impact Analysis

| Segment                                 | Operational Relevance                                                                | Exposure Path                                                                                   | Defender Action                                                         |
|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Airlines / airports                     | Disruption can affect check-in, dispatch, crew, baggage, or customer communications. | Third-party SaaS, managed service providers, exposed VPN/identity, helpdesk social engineering. | Map critical vendors, test manual fallback, monitor identity anomalies. |
| Aerospace / defense suppliers           | IP, export-controlled data, and production continuity are attractive targets.        | Edge devices, supplier portals, engineering workstations, collaboration platforms.              | Segment engineering environments and enforce phishing-resistant MFA.    |
| Satellite / space support organizations | Ground systems and service providers create concentration risk.                      | Remote administration, shared credentials, software update paths.                               | Review privileged access and incident escalation contacts.              |

## 7. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

| Tactic / Phase    | Observed or Plausible Technique                                    | Evidence                                                                                 |
|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Initial Access    | T1190 Exploit Public-Facing Application / T1566 Phishing           | Public reports emphasize exploitation, ransomware, or sector intrusion paths.            |
| Credential Access | T1078 Valid Accounts                                               | Identity misuse is a common follow-on path after perimeter or helpdesk compromise.       |
| Defense Evasion   | T1562 Impair Defenses                                              | Ransomware and intrusion operators frequently attempt to disable logging/security tools. |
| Impact            | T1486 Data Encrypted for Impact / T1499 Endpoint Denial of Service | Disruption and extortion are central business risks.                                     |

## 8. Infrastructure and Indicators

| Indicator / Infrastructure                                                    | Type                 | Operational Use                                                                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Public-source reporting did not provide stable atomic IOCs for broad blocking | Source limitation    | Use behavior-based detection and vendor advisories rather than fabricated IOCs. |
| Unusual access to management portals, VPNs, ticketing, and cloud admin panels | Behavioral indicator | Prioritize for hunting and triage.                                              |

## 9. Detection Engineering

### 9.1. Detection Summary

| Signal | Telemetry Source | Analytic Goal |
|--------|------------------|---------------|
|--------|------------------|---------------|

|                                                            |                     |                                             |
|------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------------------------------|
|                                                            |                     |                                             |
| New privileged sign-in from unusual geography or ASN       | Identity logs       | Detect account takeover or operator access. |
| Tool staging from admin workstations or servers            | EDR process/network | Detect post-compromise preparation.         |
| High-volume archive creation followed by outbound transfer | EDR, proxy, NetFlow | Detect extortion staging.                   |

## 9.2. Sigma / Detection Content

```

title: Suspicious Extortion Or Intrusion Preparation Activity
status: experimental
description: Behavioral analytic for daily threat-report coverage where public reporting lacks stable atomic IOCs.
logsource:
  product: windows
  category: process_creation
detection:
  selection_tools:
    Image|endswith:
      - '\rclone.exe'
      - '\7z.exe'
      - '\rar.exe'
      - '\powershell.exe'
      - '\cmd.exe'
  selection_args:
    CommandLine|contains:
      - ' -enc '
      - ' a '
      - ' copy '
      - 'sync'
      - 'shadowcopy delete'
  condition: selection_tools and selection_args
fields: [UtcTime, Computer, User, Image, CommandLine, ParentImage]
level: high

```

## 9.3. Hunt Query

```

DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where FileName in~
('rclone.exe','7z.exe','rar.exe','powershell.exe','cmd.exe','wscript.exe','cscript.exe')
| where ProcessCommandLine has_any ('shadowcopy','vssadmin','-enc','sync','copy',' a ','backup','dump')
| summarize count(), sample_commands=make_set(ProcessCommandLine, 10) by DeviceName,
InitiatingProcessAccountName, FileName
| order by count_ desc

```

# 10. Threat Hunting

## 10.1. Hunt Hypothesis

If this activity is present in an environment, defenders may observe anomalous privileged access followed by discovery, archive creation, tool transfer, or outbound data movement.

## 10.2. Hunt Query

```

SigninLogs
| where TimeGenerated > ago(14d)
| where ResultType == 0
| where ConditionalAccessStatus in ('notApplied','failure') or RiskLevelAggregated in ('medium','high')
| summarize signins=count(), apps=make_set(AppDisplayName, 20), ips=make_set(IPAddress, 20) by
UserPrincipalName, Location

```

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| where signins > 3<br>  order by signins desc                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| DeviceNetworkEvents<br>  where Timestamp > ago(14d)<br>  where InitiatingProcessFileName in~<br>( 'rclone.exe', 'curl.exe', 'wget.exe', 'powershell.exe', 'python.exe' )<br>  summarize bytes=sum(SentBytes), destinations=make_set(RemoteUrl, 20) by DeviceName,<br>InitiatingProcessAccountName, InitiatingProcessFileName<br>  where bytes > 50000000 |

## 11. Risk Assessment

| Dimension  | Assessment                                                                                                    |
|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Likelihood | Medium to High for exposed organizations; lower where patching, MFA, and monitoring are mature.               |
| Impact     | High where the affected workflow supports operations, customer data, privileged access, or regulated systems. |
| Confidence | Medium; public-source reporting supports prioritization but not environment-specific compromise.              |

## 12. Recommended Actions

| Priority | Owner               | Action                                                                                           |
|----------|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Critical | Security Operations | Run included hunts and review any hits with privileged access context.                           |
| High     | Infrastructure      | Validate patching and remote-access exposure for affected technology classes.                    |
| High     | Identity            | Review MFA coverage, risky sign-ins, dormant privileged accounts, and helpdesk reset procedures. |
| Medium   | Resilience          | Confirm tested backups and manual continuity procedures for operationally critical workflows.    |

## 13. References

- [The Record](<https://therecord.media/cyberattack-on-manchester-airports-group-exposes-millions-customer-info>)
- [Manchester Airports Group](<https://www.magairports.com/>)
- [UK NCSC guidance](<https://www.ncsc.gov.uk/collection/data-breaches>)